Lena Varga-Holm

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with experience owning ingestion and orchestration for a production data platform, building streaming and batch pipelines, and improving data warehouse performance. Works across Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Snowflake and AWS data services. Delivered a streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, shortened a nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes, and reduced Snowflake costs through warehouse and storage optimization.

CORE SKILLS

Data platform engineering: Production data platform operations, data ingestion, orchestration, streaming and batch processing
Programming and transformation: Python, SQL, PySpark, dbt
Data platforms and tools: Snowflake, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Airflow, Debezium, PostgreSQL
Cloud and warehouse: AWS MSK, AWS EMR, S3, Redshift, Glue Data Catalog
Quality and delivery: Great Expectations, dbt tests, pytest, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Terraform

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. | 2022–Present

- Owns data platform ingestion and orchestration across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka.
- Participates in the data platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Mentors two mid-level engineers and runs data platform office hours.
- Reduced the Snowflake bill from approximately $38,000 per month to $24,000 per month in 2024 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend configuration and removal of unused tables.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay | 2019–2022

- Built PySpark data processing on AWS EMR and designed Redshift warehouse solutions.
- Developed data quality checks using Great Expectations.
- Built PySpark batch jobs matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing finance team's manual reconciliation work from about three days to about four hours per month-end.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Shipment Event Streaming Pipeline | Lukovac Freight Hub | 2023

- Designed and built a streaming pipeline for shipment tracking events from courier partners, processing around 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95.
- Used partner webhooks to feed Kafka topics and Kafka Connect to deliver events to Snowflake via Snowpipe Streaming.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling to reprocess failed events without data loss.
- Technologies: Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Python, Terraform, AWS MSK.

Change Data Capture from Postgres | Lukovac Freight Hub | 2024

- Replaced hourly full-table extracts of the orders database with Debezium change data capture into Kafka.
- Reduced replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to approximately 25%.
- Technologies: Debezium, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Airflow, Snowflake.

dbt Migration of the Warehouse | Lukovac Freight Hub | 2022–2023

- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt models with tests and documentation.

- Introduced incremental models and slim CI using state:modified in GitHub Actions.
- Cut the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes and made lineage visible to analysts.
- Technologies: dbt, Snowflake, SQL, GitHub Actions.

Transaction Reconciliation Engine | Kovalent Pay | 2020–2021

- Built PySpark batch jobs on EMR to match bank settlement files against internal ledgers.
- Reduced manual reconciliation work from about three days to about four hours per month-end.
- Technologies: PySpark, AWS EMR, S3, Glue Data Catalog, Redshift, Great Expectations.

Open-Source Contribution | 2023

- Fixed a pagination bug and added tests in a community Airflow provider package for a SaaS CRM API; two pull requests were merged.
- Technologies: Python, Airflow, pytest.

EDUCATION

MSc in Computer Science | Northgate Technical University
Thesis: Incremental materialized views

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024

COMMUNITY

SQL instructor for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
Speaker, “Data contracts without the hype,” regional data meetup, 2024.